

a difference. The primary point is that though it consumes more power than other short range technologies, it has options such as accessing free internet through hotspots. Ask anyone the easiest way of connecting to the internet using a laptop, and the answer would most likely be Wi-Fi. The term itself has become so synonymous with Wireless LAN, it's obvious that the brand has made a good image and reputation for itself.

With better specifications coming out and Bluetooth also jumping onto the 802.11 protocol, Wi-Fi is obviously here to stay. Also, developments over the years have reduced the cost of WLAN hardware greatly.

In several cities in the USA, almost all of their technology is wireless, with internet accessible via mobile and laptop. The scope for a municipal wireless network is there and the potential is huge. A city-wide network would facilitate better data sharing, better information broadcasting, better public systems and better internet on the go. We in India have realised the value of e-Governance. But cities such as San Francisco have initiated systems so that a person can report, say, small city problems such as open drains on a real time platform (Twitter). Any real time work or internet-on-the-go is possible only with the help of wireless local area networks. A Wi-Fi enabled system can do most of the things any other wireless technology can do, but the focus is on speed and widespread easy-to-access connectivity. And Wi-Fi has clearly proved its place.